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CS 461 Senior Software Engineering
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UI Wireframe and Proof of Concept: AgRoutes

Introduction

With only five days between our Team Requirements doc and this deadline, I knew the timeline would be tight. But I chose this activity because building low-fi wireframes for two of our MVP user stories and turning them into a clickable proof of concept forced thinking through the taskflow design, and that was needed. So, I selected this for what the process teaches, and the useful artifacts it produces.

Result: published publicly on my school GitHub account, MargaretSey https://margaretsey.github.io/AgRoutes/

User flows and Scenarios to Proof of Concept

These came from the work on the Team Requirements document.

User Story 1: Sign up and find a ride to share Ross, a Corvallis farmer, hears there's a better way to share delivery costs, checks out AgRoutes, and finds a ride to share.

- **Start:** Sign in with a mobile number and texted code (no password needed)
- Set up your farm (home base, type, products, refrigerated truck, privacy)
- Home → Find a trip → Results
- Open Dana's Springfield food hub trip and see the miles saved
- Message Dana → add insurance certificate → approved
- **Outcome:** Message sent, waiting for Dana's reply

User Story 2: Accept a first shared ride Dana replies, and Ross accepts his first shared ride.

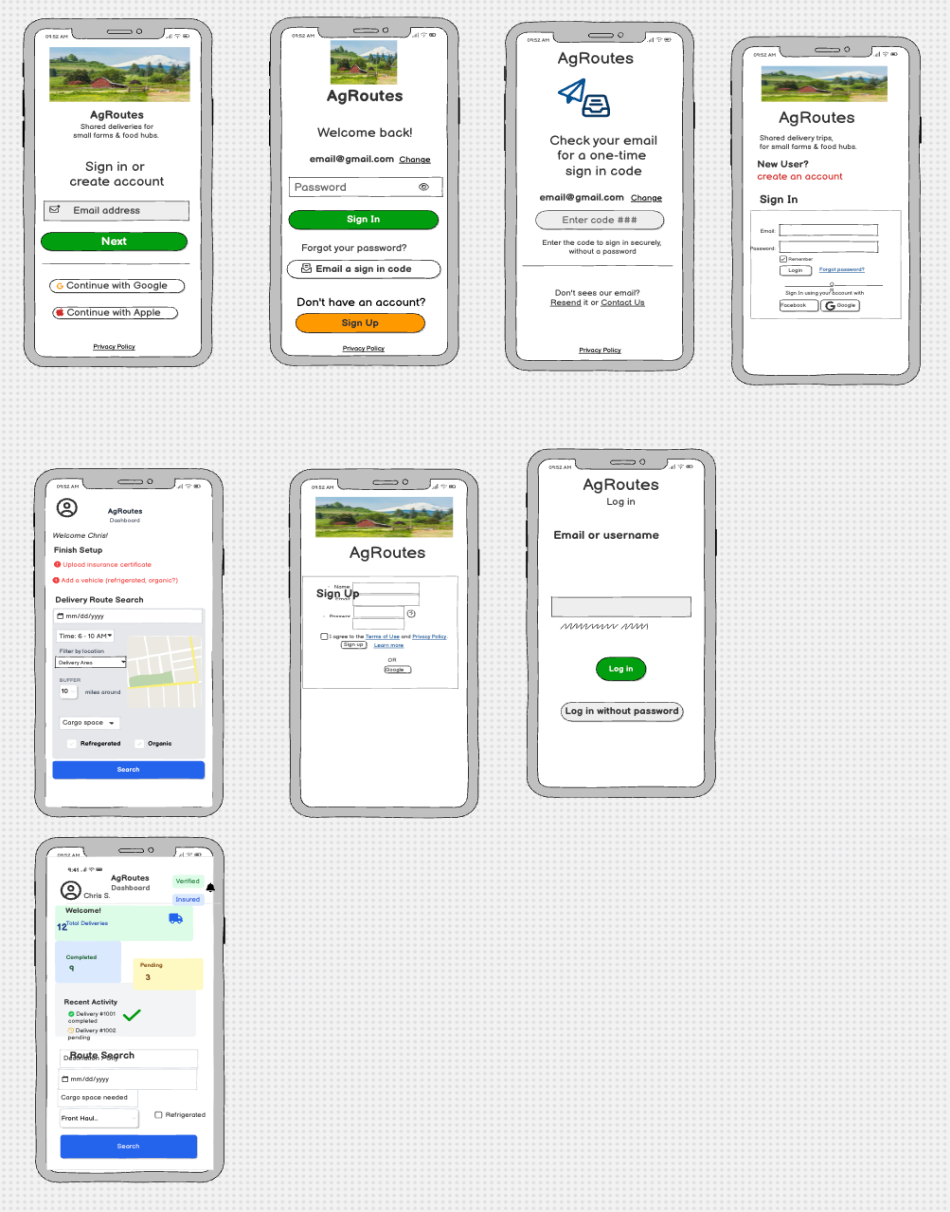
- **Start:** Sign in with phone and code
- Home shows "New message from Dana"
- Read the reply and the "You're agreeing to" summary
- Optional: message Dana a question and get an answer
- Accept
- **Outcome:** Home shows the upcoming drop-off with an automatic reminder; Your trips lists it as booked
- **Alternate path:** Decline shows other trips for that day, including a new match

Wireframing the User Story Taskflows

Step 1) Balsamiq

1. For this assignment I first created a wireframe in Balsamiq, with is a low-fi tool I like for its low point of entry, to begin wireframing the taskflow. Here are the screens I created:

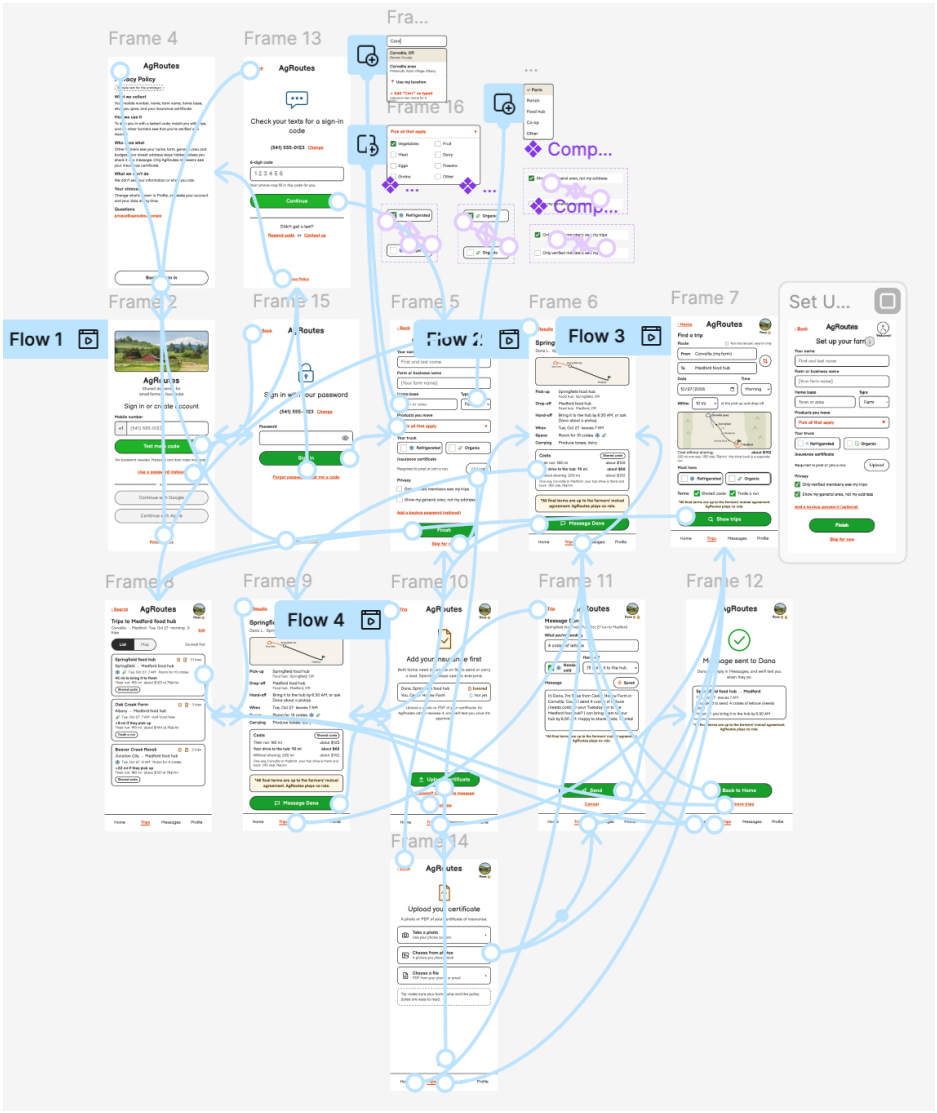
   Initial User Story 1 Sign Up screens



Step 2) Figma Screens for 2 User Stories

I got feedback on the initial look. Then I imported the Balsamiq screens to Figma, created two separate User Stories files, and added the actions between screens. You can see the clickable links in the Prototype view.

User Story 1 in Figma Prototype mode



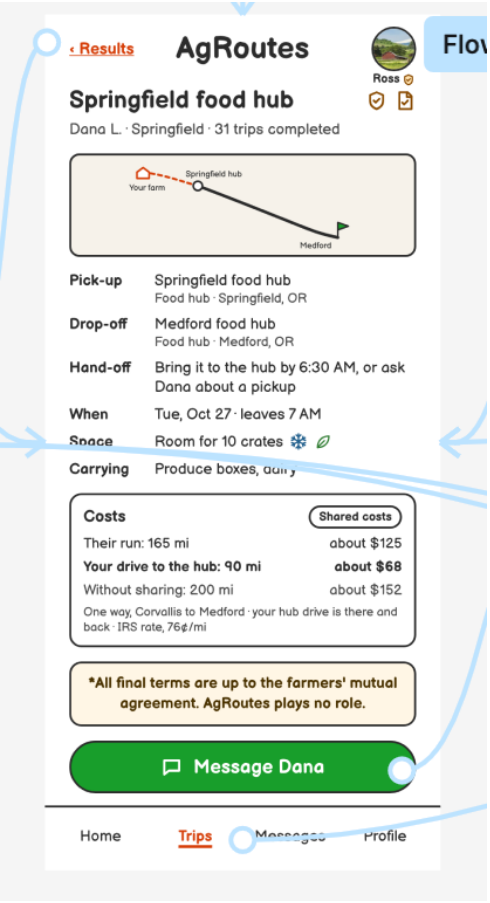
Step 3) HTML Clickable Wireframes

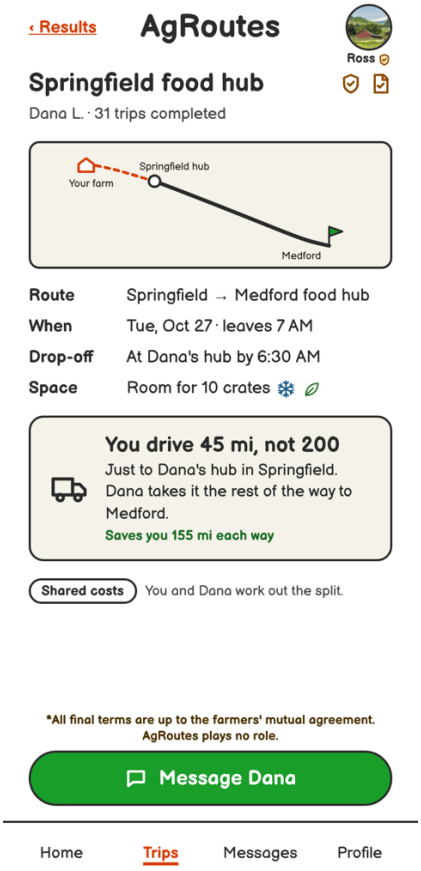
The file was then converted to html and placed on my GitHub repo to share, and for updating.

Proof of Concept (clickable): https://margaretsey.github.io/AgRoutes/

Revision

Trip screen, before and after





- Cut eight detail rows to four: route, when, drop-off, space
- Replaced a three-line cost box with one clear benefit: **"You drive 45 mi, not 200. Saves you 155 mi each way."**
- Named only Ross and Dana, removing "they" and "without sharing"
- Made the disclaimer quieter but kept it on every screen

Stakeholder and user feedback

The only time I had at this step was for a Usability Design Review with my husband, so I did that at least to have some general feedback. **Questions asked:** Where did you hesitate? What's confusing? What felt easy to do?

Source	What worked	Suggested improvement	What I did
Instructor (team requirements review)	Requirements, risk analysis and MVP scope on target	Let farmers talk before confirming a trip; reveal	Added message-before-accept path; location reveal

Source	What worked	Suggested improvement	What I did
		location only after; watch hosting costs	planned next round; free GitHub Pages hosting
Design review of the Trip screen	Map and route easy to read	Screen too busy; cost box confusing; "their run" implied a third person	Rebuilt the Trip screen (see revision below)
Stakeholder 1: [name, role]	[add]	[add]	[add]
Stakeholder 2: [name, role]	[add]	[add]	[add]

Reflection

- AgRoutes core ides is that the app introduces two farmers and then gets out of the way. That drives the main choices: phone sign-in with no password to remember, open search so farmers see value before committing, an insurance check only at the moment of contact, and in-app messaging that keeps addresses private.
- The hand-drawn Balsamiq style was kept on purpose so as to focus on the flow, not the polish, and I tried to hatch anything out that’s not live, so at not to get lost. The biggest revision came from feedback that the trip screen was too busy and confusing.
- This got me to thinking about a new **key question**: What are the clear benefits to participating for the user, and how do we surface them along the stpes?
    - "You drive 45 mi, not 200" for example, and we must surface those (but not promise them) in the app.
- I added a path to ask Dana a question and get an answer before accepting. Communication build trust, and in the end it’s the farmers making the routes, not the app. Both changes made the value easier to see and the flow more trustworthy, I think.